

NAGALAND LITERACY AND NUMERACY FEST 2026

Micro-Improvement Project (Literacy Teacher) — Grade 5

Voices for the Voiceless — Chapter 7: The Hunt (Comic Storytelling)

Why this Micro-Improvement Project (MIP)?

Grade 5 students have been building their reading and writing skills with English storybooks, but comprehension is only the first step in understanding a story deeply enough to retell it, in the right sequence, in one's own grammatically correct words, is what turns reading into real literacy. This project uses the Class 5 English chapter 'The Hunt' the story of a boy who unexpectedly befriends a wild dog in the forest as a doorway into that deeper reading and writing. Nagaland's forests are never far from its villages and schools, and animals, wild or stray, sometimes wander close by. Students read 'The Hunt' for comprehension, then create an original comic book, told from a human's or an animal's point of view, that helps readers understand and treat animals with more kindness.

Leading Question: How can we help people respect animals instead of fearing or harming them?

Skill in Focus: Reading Comprehension & Narrative Sequencing, and Grammatically Correct Descriptive/Narrative Writing (through Comic Storytelling)

Duration: 1 Week (40 minutes daily, across 5 days)

Learning Outcome

- Read the text with comprehension, locating details and the sequence of events.
- Uses meaningful, grammatically correct sentences to describe and narrate incidents.
- Read independently in English storybooks and talk about them.

Key Concepts

- Reads and comprehends a narrative text, identifying the storyline and the sequence of events.
- Tells a story with a clear beginning, middle, and end.
- Uses complete, grammatically correct sentences with appropriate punctuation to narrate incidents.
- Communicates a message effectively by combining visuals and text.

Competency Addressed

C-2.3: “Understands main ideas and draws essential conclusions from the material read.”

This competency anchors the MIP’s focus on close reading: learners identify what happens in ‘The Hunt’, draw their own conclusion about kindness toward animals, and then express that conclusion through an original comic.

Detailed Tasks

Task-1

Meet ‘The Hunt’ — Introduce the Project and Begin Reading

Objective

To introduce the project and leading question, set up group-work norms, and begin reading ‘The Hunt’ (Pg. 28–29) with comprehension, so students start connecting the story to real encounters with animals.

Teacher's Note

Set 3 simple rules with the class before starting (e.g. listen kindly, everyone has a job, ask for help) revisit these on the final day. Read aloud slowly from Pg. 28 up to ‘...almost hidden by the bushes,’ pausing so students can underline unfamiliar words.

Duration

35 minutes

Materials Needed

English textbook (Chapter 7 — The Hunt) • Notebook and pencil • Board space for the class PBL rules

Activity Steps

- 1.Introducing micro improvement and the leading question: ‘How can we inspire empathy and kindness toward animals through storytelling?’ Set 3 class rules for group work together.
- 2.Pair work: students close their eyes and imagine meeting a hurt or scared animal on a quiet path, then discuss with a partner what animal they imagined and what they would do; invite 2–3 pairs to share.
- 3.Connect to context: animals sometimes wander near villages or schools in Nagaland, and not all are dangerous; some are lost, hungry, or in pain. Introduce comics as a way to tell an animal’s story.
- 4.Read aloud from Pg. 28 to ‘...almost hidden by the bushes,’ asking students to underline unfamiliar words as they follow along.

5.Pair discussion using guiding questions: what happened so far; what the boy meant by ‘don’t you have to go back to your pack?’; what relationship is forming; why the boy stayed; is the boy brave? Invite a few pairs to share.

Homework Extension

Talk to a family member or neighbour about a time they helped an animal, or saw someone do it, and write 2–3 lines about what they said.

Concept Built

Reading a narrative with comprehension by following along, underlining new vocabulary, and discussing what has happened and why while connecting the story to real, local experiences with animals.

Task-2

Complete the Story and Brainstorm the Comic’s Message & Character

Objective	To finish reading ‘The Hunt’, discuss its meaning as a class, and begin planning the comic by deciding on a message and a main character.
Teacher’s Note	Divide students into fixed groups of 4–5 for the rest of the project, mixing different abilities and learning levels in each group. Read aloud from ‘Every nerve in his...’ to the end of the story.
Duration	35 minutes

Materials Needed

English textbook • Notebook and pencil

Activity Steps

- 1.Recap what happened in the first half of the story, and briefly share what students found from their homework family interviews.
- 2.Form fixed groups of 4–5 students, mixing different abilities, for the rest of the project.
- 3.Read aloud the rest of ‘The Hunt’ (from ‘Every nerve in his...’ to the end); groups discuss how the boy and the dog helped each other, how the boy felt seeing the wild pig, what he learned, and whether kindness can change how we see animals.

4.Groups begin planning their comic: decide the message they want readers to feel or learn, and choose whether their main character will be a human or an animal, writing both down in one short sentence each.

Homework Extension

Each student writes a **short letter or postcard (5–6 sentences)** from their point of view of the character (human or animal) whichever their group chose.

Concept Built

Comprehending a complete narrative and drawing a conclusion that kindness can change how animals and people relate then translating that understanding into a message and character for original storytelling.

Task-3

Plan the Story and Layout the Comic Frames

Objective	To plan a complete story arc (beginning, middle, end) for the comic, and lay that story out across a sequence of comic frames.
Teacher's Note	Check homework answers together first (Question D: cluster, prickle, whimpered, whiff, cautiously). Remind groups that every story needs a clear beginning, a problem, a change, and an ending.
Duration	30 minutes

Materials Needed

Plain paper for the rough layout • Pencil • Ruler (optional, for frames)

Activity Steps

- 1.Check homework answers together, then recall the project's leading question and how the story connects to it.
- 2.Groups plan their story in 5–6 lines: where it starts, what the problem or challenge is, what changes, and how it ends what the characters learn or feel.
- 3.Introduce comic frames: a comic is made of frames read left to right, top to bottom, each showing one moment in the story.
- 4.Groups divide their story into 9–10 frames and sketch a simple rough layout showing what happens in each frame.

Homework Extension

Complete any pending discussion on the story and layout.

Concept Built

Structuring a narrative with a clear sequence of events beginning, problem, change, ending and translating that sequence into a visual, frame-by-frame plan.

Task-4

Give Peer Feedback and Create the Final Comic

Objective

To revise the comic using peer feedback, then create the final version using clear sentences, narration, and visuals to communicate the story.

Teacher's Note

Pair two groups together for feedback, focused on the content story clarity and message rather than appearance. Remind students to use correct tenses in narration text and to check punctuation in speech and thought bubbles.

Duration

30 minutes

Materials Needed

Chart paper or notebook paper • Colour pens or pencils • Their rough layout from Task-3

Activity Steps

- 1.Groups review their story and layout together, and identify anything they disagree on or are especially proud of.
- 2.Peer feedback: paired groups exchange work and answer Is the story clear? Is the message clear? Is it engaging? Is anything confusing or missing?
- 3.Groups discuss the feedback they received and decide which changes to make to their final draft.
- 4.Final creation: groups use their layout to draw illustrations, add narration text (using correct tenses), speech and thought bubbles, and sound effects where useful, then choose a title for their comic.

Homework Extension

Complete any pending work on the comic book.

Concept Built

Giving and using constructive feedback to revise a story, then combining grammatically correct narration, dialogue, and illustration to communicate a message clearly.

Culminating Showcase

Showcase

Comic Book Showcase and Reflection

Objective

To share and celebrate each group's comic with the class, and reflect individually on what was learned about storytelling, empathy, and teamwork.

Teacher's Note

Encourage specific, appreciative feedback rather than generic praise. Revisit the PBL rules set on Day 1, keeping the final list to five or fewer, adding any new rules the class votes on. Display finished comics in the library or a designated area afterward.

Duration

30 minutes

Materials Needed

Finished comic books • Notebook for individual reflection notes

Activity Steps

- 1.Groups exchange comic books and read each other's work, noting one thing they appreciate and one element they would like to use in their own writing.
- 2.Groups discuss their observations together and nominate a presenter to share specific feedback with the class (e.g. what was creative, clear, or engaging about another group's comic).
- 3.Independent reflection: students answer questions such as what they enjoyed most, whether their feelings about animals changed, what they would do if they saw a hurt or scared animal, and what they would do differently next time.
- 4.As a class, revisit the PBL rules from Task-1, discuss which helped, which didn't, and vote on any new rules, keeping the final list to five or fewer.
5. Display the finished comics in the school library or a designated area for others to enjoy.

Concept Built

Reading and responding to a peer's storytelling with specific, constructive feedback, and reflecting in writing on personal learning, empathy, and collaboration.

By the end of these tasks, students should have moved from reading a story about a boy and a wild dog to confidently reading with comprehension, narrating their own story in grammatically correct sentences, and expressing empathy for animals through an original comic they can showcase with pride.

Extending & Adapting the Project

Additional Enrichment Activities

- Research an endangered or commonly misunderstood animal (e.g. leopards, wild pigs, owls) and make a short profile with facts, myths, and ways people can help them.
- Write a persuasive letter to the village council, headteacher, or a local newspaper suggesting how the community can treat animals more humanely.

Modifications for Simplification

- Provide supportive sentence starters and key vocabulary from the textbook to help learners express their ideas clearly.
- Learners can reduce the number of comic book frames to share their story.

Micro-Improvement Cycle of Literacy Teacher

In this MIP you focused on:

- Helping students read a narrative text with comprehension, locating details and the sequence of events.
- Guiding students to discuss a story's meaning with peers and draw their own conclusions from it.
- Supporting students to describe and narrate incidents using complete, grammatically correct sentences.
- Encouraging students to express a clear message by combining visuals and text in an original comic.
- Building empathy by helping students recognise the feelings and perspectives of animals and people alike.
- Guiding students to collaborate planning, giving feedback on, and revising a shared piece of writing.
- Using a familiar Nagaland context, animals near villages and schools connect the textbook chapter to everyday life.

Reflect on Students' Understanding

Observe 5–6 students each day during the tasks above. No written test is needed to watch what students do while reading, planning, and drawing, and listen to how they explain their thinking.

Student Name	Reads With Comprehension & Locates Details	Narrates Using Correct, Meaningful Sentences	Reads Independently & Talks About It	Needs Support
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐

Scale (for each column): ☐ Not Yet ☐ Sometimes ☐ Consistently

